

Supplementary Material

Three Equivalent Routes to Estimating Power Spectra: Averaging, Multitaper, and Smoothing

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Figure, table and equation numbers without an “S” refer to the main text.

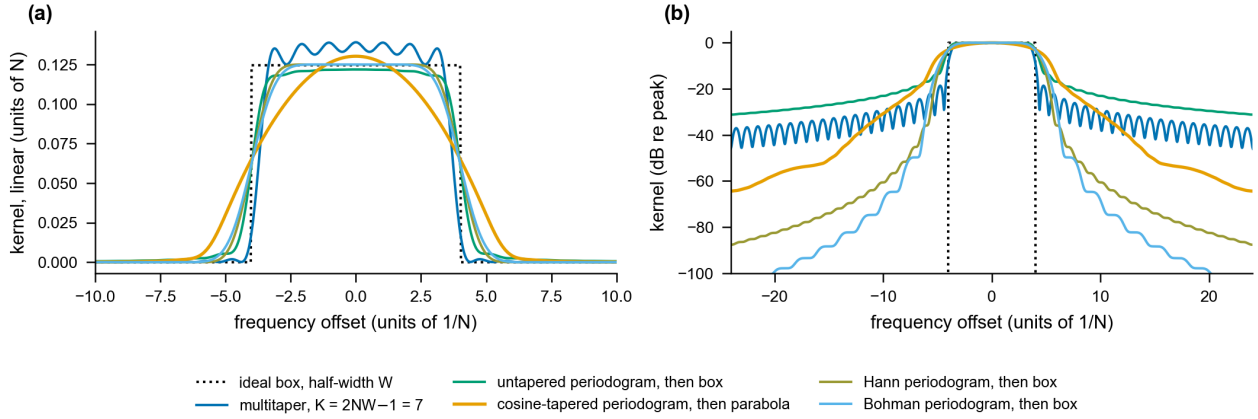


Figure S1: Kernels at the same design bandwidth ($N = 256$, $W = 4/N$; Table II): (a) on a linear scale near the main lobe and (b) in dB relative to the peak. The ideal box; the $K = 7$ multitaper kernel ($\nu = 14.0$); the periodogram after a 25% cosine taper followed by a parabola of the same half-power width ($\nu = 16.7$), which is recipe (b’); and the untapered ($\nu = 17.2$), Hann ($\nu = 8.9$) and Bohman ($\nu = 7.3$) periodograms followed by the box. All main lobes have nearly the same half-power width, and the skirts differ by 40 dB.

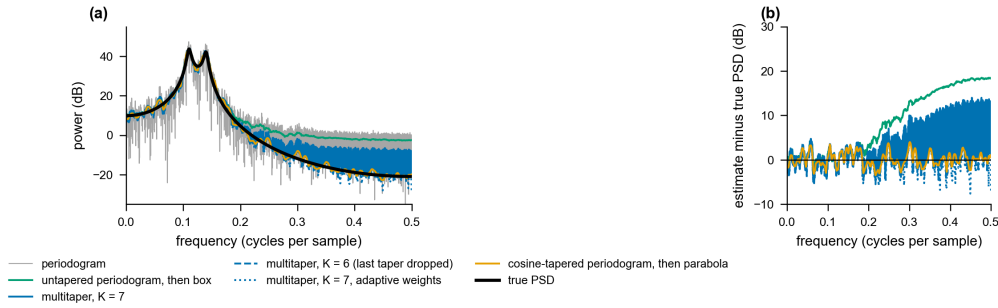


Figure S2: Dropping the leakiest taper. (a) One realization of the AR(4) process ($N = 1024$, $W = 4/N$): the periodogram ($\nu = 2$, grey); the untapered periodogram smoothed with the box ($\nu = 17.2$, green); the equal-weight multitaper estimate with $K = 7$ ($\nu = 14$, solid blue) and with $K = 6$ ($\nu = 12$, dashed blue), and the adaptively weighted estimate with $K = 7$ (dotted blue); the cosine-tapered periodogram smoothed with a parabola of half-power width $2W$ ($\nu = 16.7$, orange); and the true PSD (black). (b) Each smoothed estimate minus the true PSD: the untapered box floors 20 dB high, $K = 7$ floors 10 dB high, dropping the seventh taper halves that, and the adaptive weights and the smoothed periodogram track the truth.

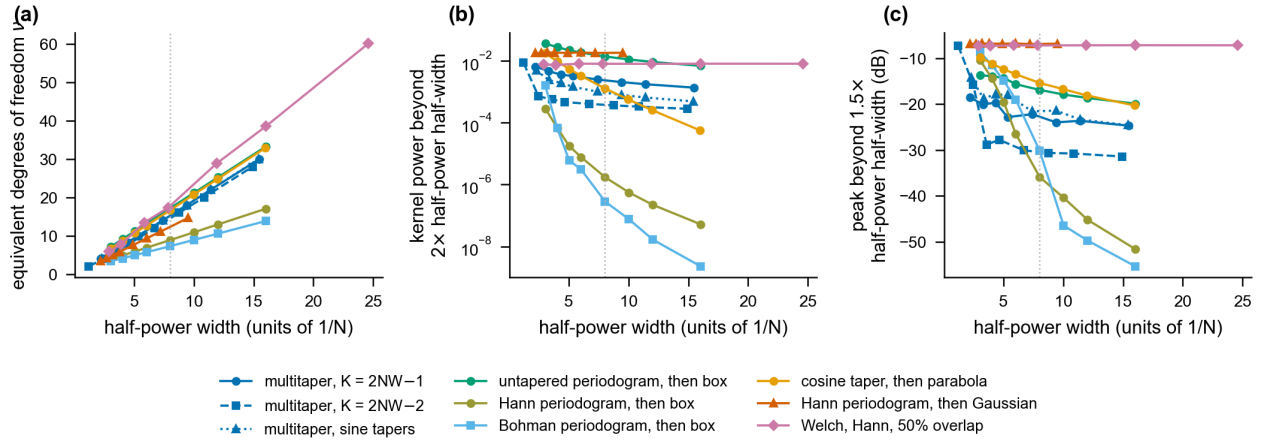


Figure S3: Variance, leakage and side-lobe level versus measured resolution for $N = 256$. All curves are exact kernel and degrees-of-freedom computations, with no sampling variability. Each method's bandwidth parameter is swept and the quantities are plotted against the resulting half-power width, so methods are compared at equal resolution: multitaper with $K = 2NW - 1$ and $2NW - 2$ Slepian tapers and with sine tapers; untapered, Hann and Bohman periodograms followed by a box; a cosine-tapered periodogram followed by a parabola; a Hann periodogram followed by a Gaussian; Welch's method with 50% overlap. (a) Equivalent degrees of freedom ν (higher means less variance). (b) Kernel power beyond twice the half-power half-width. (c) The peak of the kernel beyond $1.5 \times$ the half-power half-width. The Gaussian, parabolic and Welch kernels have no flat top, so for them this quantity is the skirt of the main lobe and not a side lobe. The dotted line marks the $8/N$ width of Table II.

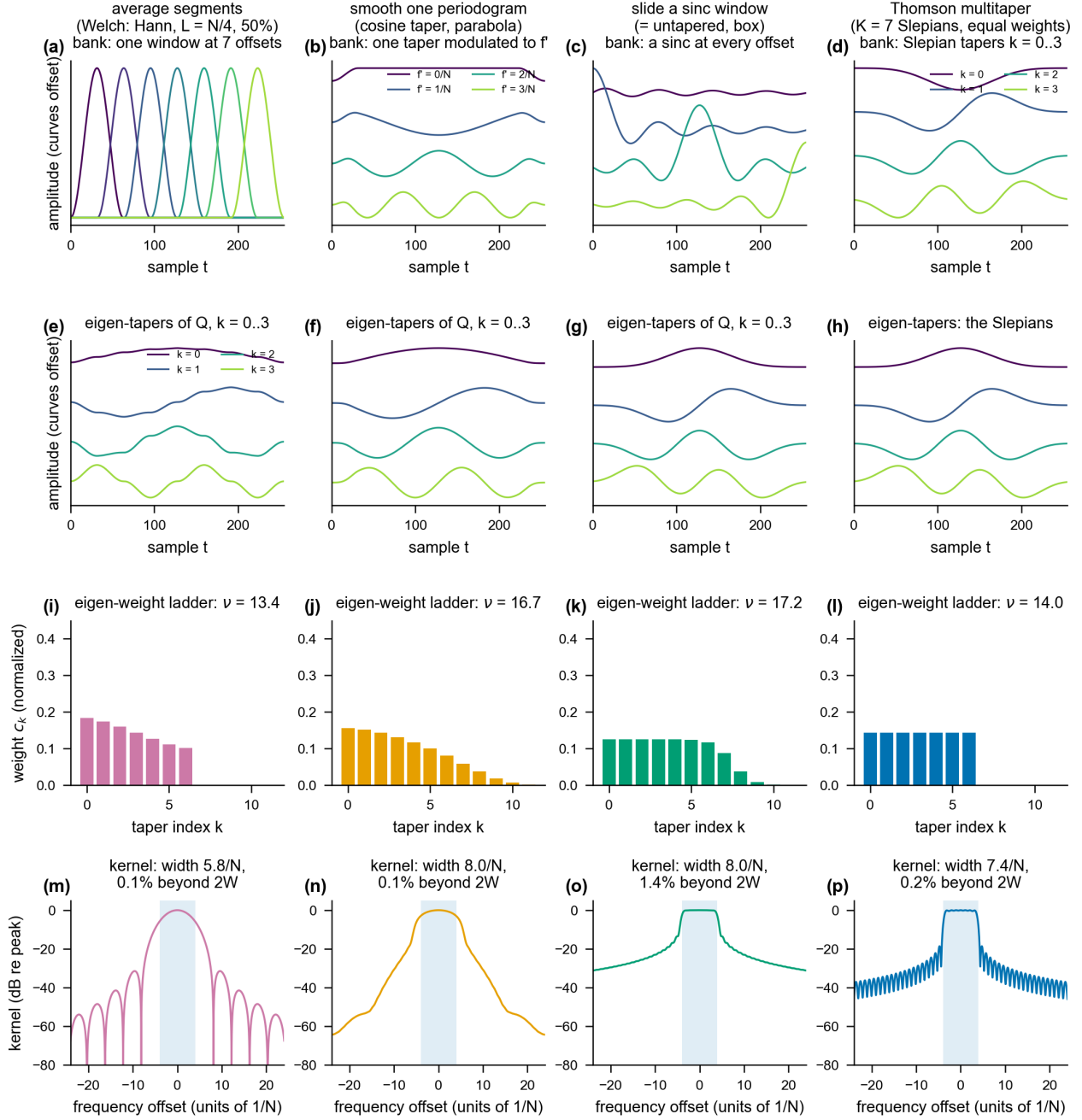


Figure S4: Fig. 5 in full. Columns as in Fig. 5; rows: the bank as constructed (a–d), the first four eigen-tapers of Q (e–h; for the sliding sinc they are the Slepian sequences, and for Thomson’s estimate, whose weights are equal, the Slepian are one of many orthonormal bases of the span), the eigen-weight ladder (i–l), and the kernel in dB relative to its peak with its half-power width and the fraction of its power beyond $2W$ (m–p; shading $|f| \leq W$).